



INITIATIVE BRIEF

Establish Reliable Application Inventory and System of Record

Draft narrative was generated from interview responses and should be reviewed before approval. Supporting facts are attributed to interview or Jira; potential success measures are suggestions, not accepted targets.

Initiative Type: Internal Productivity

Department: Operations

Submitter: Browser v165 Reviewer

Business Owner: Not yet provided

Executive Sponsor: Not yet provided

Status: Draft

Executive Summary

Application information is scattered across disconnected sources, forcing IT and business teams to repeatedly rediscover ownership, business purpose and dependencies. This fragmentation slows troubleshooting, onboarding, renewals and changes, and creates security and compliance risk through unclear accountability and dependence on institutional knowledge. Establishing a reliable centralized inventory with documented ownership and business purpose, validated by business owners and administered by IT, is expected to accelerate operational activities, improve visibility for security and audit functions, and reduce knowledge loss risk when personnel transition.

Business Need

Problem / Opportunity: Application information is fragmented across spreadsheets, email, team wikis and individual knowledge, leaving ownership and dependencies unclear. IT and business teams waste time rediscovering information, finding the right people, and supporting troubleshooting, onboarding, renewals and changes. Dependence on institutional knowledge creates security, compliance and operational continuity risk.

Current State / Process: Application information is maintained in disconnected sources including spreadsheets, email, team wikis and individual knowledge. Ownership and business purpose are often unclear or known only to specific individuals. IT and business teams must rediscover information for each troubleshooting, onboarding, renewal or change activity.

Business Impact: IT and business teams waste time rediscovering application information and finding the right people. Troubleshooting and onboarding are slower. Renewals and changes are harder because information is incomplete.

Proposed Future State

Desired Outcome: Phase 1 should start with application ownership and business purpose. IT would administer the inventory and business owners would validate their records. A reliable system of record for applications would make ownership and business purpose clear. We want faster troubleshooting and onboarding, less rediscovery, better renewal and change support, reduced dependence on specific individuals, and better visibility for security reviews, audits and employee transitions.

High-level Approach: Not yet established

Expected Business Value

Qualitative Value: This Initiative could save \$75,000 annually.

Monthly hours saved: Not yet established

Revenue opportunity: Not yet established

Cost savings: Not yet established

Success Measures

Success measures have not yet been finalized.

Potential Success Measures (suggestions, not accepted):

Suggested measure: Time to locate application ownership and business purpose information (measured as reduction in rediscovery cycles or support requests)

Suggested measure: Reduction in onboarding and troubleshooting duration attributable to centralized application inventory access



Risks, Constraints & Unknowns

Risks / Considerations: Unclear ownership and dependencies create security and compliance exposure. Credential-management visibility is limited. Dependence on institutional knowledge creates a risk of knowledge loss when people leave.

Critical unknown: Who is the accountable business owner and which department will sponsor this initiative?

Critical unknown: Success metric not established

Future discovery: What is the total number of applications and which source systems must be inventoried in Phase 1?

Future discovery: What are the specific compliance and audit requirements that drive visibility needs?

Future discovery: What budget and resource capacity is available for Phase 1 implementation?

Recommended Next Steps

Confirm the accountable business owner and department. Resolve the critical unknowns that affect the decision to advance. Validate the qualitative benefits and develop value estimates where useful. Decide whether to advance to Project evaluation.

Current Assessment

Overall Score: 45/100 · Low (current assessment, not a decision)

Readiness: 90% — Strong Business Context

Some scoring dimensions remain unquantified; unknown values are not confirmed zero.

Business value: 25/25

Strategic alignment: 8/10

Readiness score: 10/10

Delivery confidence: 7/10

Risk / complexity: -11 (complexity -6, risk -5)

Customer impact score: 6/15

Revenue potential score: 0/15

Cost savings score: 0/15

AI readiness category: High

Technical complexity: Medium

Compliance risk: High

Supporting Context

problem (interview fact): Application information is fragmented across spreadsheets, email, team wikis and individual knowledge. Ownership and dependencies are unclear.

scope (interview fact): Phase 1 should start with application ownership and business purpose. IT would administer the inventory and business owners would validate their records.

desiredOutcome (interview fact): A reliable system of record for applications would make ownership and business purpose clear. We want faster troubleshooting and onboarding, less rediscovery, better renewal and change support, reduced dependence on specific individuals, and better visibility for security reviews, audits and employee transitions.

constraint (interview fact): The exact compliance requirements need later discovery.